

Google Chrome

Has released some basic framework for plugins/extensions, but is in preliminary stages

Foxmarks

Foxmarks is one of the best bookmark managers in our opinion as it not only manages the bookmarks on a single PC, but it syncs your bookmarks across multiple PCs. You can get this either via www.mozilla.com, or alternatively from www.foxmarks.com directly. To use the syncing service you will need to sign up which you can do either at the web site, or during installation. Once that's done, your bookmarks will be loaded onto their server and when you login with Foxmarks on another PC, it will sync the two. Another feature offered by Foxmarks is that it allows you to access your bookmarks from anywhere through their online service. For this you just need to login at my.foxmarks.com. You can also create profiles and categorise your bookmarks for efficiently browsing through your bookmarks.

Multimedia Add-ons

FoxyTunes

The FoxyTunes add-on integrates a tiny media player control with Firefox. This is great for those of you who listen to music while browsing, as you can now control your music from the browser itself, instead of switching to the music player. There is a long list of players from which you can choose; we used this add-on on Windows Media Player and VLC and didn't face the slightest problem. The song title is also displayed in a small section at the bottom of your browser where the controls are located. FoxyTunes

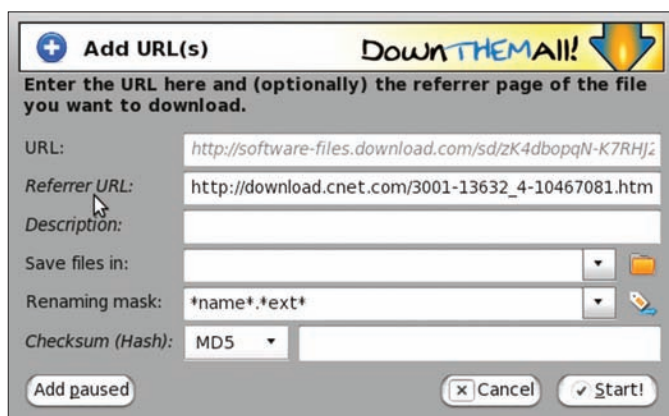


FoxyTunes offers media playback controls through Firefox

rids us of the hassle of hitting [Alt]+[Tab] to pause or switch songs, especially since this add-on has its own set of shortcut keys to play, pause, stop and skip. Not only that, with FoxyTunes there is a button next to the music controls that lets you search for images, videos and lyrics of the song you are currently listening to. Additionally, you can access online streams such as last.fm and enjoy the music from there too.

FlashGot

With the FlashGot plugin, you can quickly grab and download flash videos from streaming sites such as Youtube. You can also download all the link targets that are present on a single site by clicking FlashGot All, which is located on the contextual menu (menu displayed on right-clicking). Initially, FlashGot downloads all the content using your default download manager. However, if you are using a download manager such as Free Download Manager, it can integrate with that as well. Not only videos, but it can also grab audio while you are listening. The FlashGot Media option, which is used to grab the



DownThemAll is a download manager that integrates itself with Firefox

Firefox usage

Reports suggest that world-wide Firefox usage stands at around 30%

media, from the context menu will appear only when a streaming media clip is playing.

For your download needs

DownThemAll

DownThemAll is the first and only download manager add-on that integrates with Firefox. It's a very basic download manager and claims to accelerate downloads. You can set the maximum concurrent downloads between 1 and 10 and you can set filters for your download using file extensions; this would help manage downloads even better. If you were to use the default download feature of Firefox, all the files, regardless of their type would be downloaded and dumped into a single folder.

Gaming

The Nethernet

For those of you who like to play games while waiting for something to load or just to pass the time during work, The Nethernet (an online game based on the internet) is meant for you. If you were to classify it, it would fall under the RPG category as it has quests that you have to fulfil. These are not ordinary quests where you have to go and slay beasts and monsters; but instead, the quests have been created by fellow players themselves. These quests consist in linking web sites with a story, that actually takes you to web sites that you might not have known existed and enjoy visiting them. For example, somebody might make a quest of visiting different online comics. The Nethernet gives you a tour of the internet and along the way you get game points and unlock different badges.

After you download this add-on, you will need to register with The Nethernet. Once that's done, you will see the add-ons toolbar on your browser with a bunch of buttons. You have options to attack others by leaving mines at a web site or you could create a portal that will allow you to link the site you have visited to another that you think might be enjoyed by others. All these get integrated into your browser and there are also some special effects that occur with each one of them. You can also chat with other players going through the Nethernet. The community is quite friendly and you are sure to enjoy mixing with them.

So if you are bored at home, or at work and don't know what to do, this is the perfect add-on for you as you might rediscover the internet with this. ■

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Pass the time with The Nethernet